The recession in Eardisia has meant charities face more ‘competition’ for their supporters’ money. Charities need to find the best ways to obtain their support. However, the actions some have taken have resulted in adverse media comments, damaging the reputation of the charitable sector as a whole.

Raising funds effectively

Charities which are most successful in obtaining funds are those which have a clear strategy for using e-marketing to appeal for support. A charity’s website remains a key asset. The website must make clear what is special about the charity and show what it is achieving, convincing supporters that their money or time will be well-spent.

However, a charity’s website is likely to be viewed mostly by individuals who are already aware of the charity and are actively interested in its work. A charity needs to stimulate interest in other ways. It needs to have a media strategy which covers the diverse media viewed by the charity’s supporters and needs to use different media to promote its work, involve supporters and attract donations. The charity must also consider carefully the different ways supporters can be contacted and how messages can be sent in ways which will make an immediate impact on them. It should also be easy for supporters to contact the charity.

In all this, charities must be aware of the data produced about the impact of their activities and how they can use it to build relationships with their donors and members.

Raising funds ethically

Charities must also consider potential threats to their image caused by their fundraising practices. There have been media reports of aggressive tactics being used in face-to-face collections of money, with collectors pressurising vulnerable people. Many people have complained about being contacted too frequently by phone, email or text. Telephone callers from charities have also been criticised for not being immediately clear that they are seeking donations, or for making untrue or exaggerated claims about their charity’s activities.

Lots of people have been worried about how charities use their personal information. Many complaints have arisen from situations where charities have used third party fundraisers to raise funds on their behalf.

It has been reported that many charities have not publicised their guidelines on fundraising, or how concerns about fundraising tactics should be reported.